

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** A

Options: A) The sages of the Zhuangzi; B) The Songs of the South; C) The Duke of Zhou; D) The Confucian "sage kings"

Note: The sages of the Zhuangzi are known for their Daoist philosophy, which emphasizes naturalness and spontaneity while advocating for a withdrawal from societal conventions and political ambitions.

2. **Answer:** A

Options: A) Peace and harmony; B) Power and influence; C) Truth and love; D) Wisdom and ethics

Note: The central focus of religious traditions in China and Korea has been the pursuit of peace and harmony, which is evident in the teachings of Confucianism, Taoism, and Buddhism, each emphasizing balance, social order, and the interconnectedness of all life.

3. **Answer:** D

Options: A) Asceticism; B) Bodily pleasure; C) Music; D) Sexual union

Note: A central component of tantric Buddhism is sexual union, as it symbolizes the integration of male and female energies, which is essential for achieving spiritual enlightenment and understanding the union of opposites.

4. **Answer:** C

Options: A) Pakistan; B) Iraq; C) Indonesia; D) Turkey

Note: Indonesia is the largest Muslim country in the world, home to over 200 million adherents, which reflects its significant population and the predominance of Islam as the major religion in the nation.

5. **Answer:** C

Options: A) Toward the end of the first millennium BCE; B) Towards the middle of the first millennium BCE; C) Toward the end of the second millennium BCE; D) Toward the middle of the second millennium BCE

Note: The Old Babylonian version of Gilgamesh was modified into the standard version toward the end of the second millennium BCE as this period marked significant literary and cultural developments in Mesopotamia, leading to the consolidation of various narratives into a unified epic.

True / False

6. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The Dalai Lama is primarily known as a spiritual leader and advocate for peace, promoting non-violence and compassion rather than military leadership in Tibetan history.

7. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: In the Japanese origin myth, Amaterasu, the sun goddess, is indeed born from Izanagi's left eye as part of the creation narrative that describes the origins of the gods in Shinto belief.

8. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The statement is true because Haiku poetry embodies the principles of Zen Buddhism by focusing on simplicity, brevity, and a deep appreciation of nature, reflecting the meditative and contemplative aspects of Zen thought.

9. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: Amaterasu is actually a Shinto goddess, not a bodhisattva, and is primarily associated with the sun and the heavens rather than dedicating herself to alleviating the suffering of others, which is the role of a bodhisattva in Buddhism.

10. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The kshatriyas and shramanas did not unite to promote bhakti devotionals against Brahminic beliefs, as bhakti emerged later as a distinct devotional movement primarily among various social groups, including some Brahmins, rather than being a unified effort between these two classes.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** The Caliphate played a crucial role in Islamic history as it represented the political and religious leadership of the Muslim community after the death of the Prophet Muhammad. Caliphs were seen as the successors to the Prophet, responsible for upholding Islamic law and guiding the community in spiritual and worldly matters. This leadership helped to unify the diverse Muslim population and facilitated the spread of Islam across various regions. The Caliphate also influenced the development of Islamic culture, governance, and scholarship, making it a significant institution in shaping the identity of the Muslim community. Through their leadership, Caliphs not only maintained order but also inspired a sense of belonging among Muslims, reinforcing the importance of shared faith and community.

Note: correct because it emphasizes the Caliphate's role as the political and religious leadership following the Prophet Muhammad, highlighting the significance of Caliphs in unifying the Muslim community and promoting the spread of Islam, which were essential for the development of the Islamic faith and society.

12. **Answer:** Janam-sakhis are significant in Sikh literature because they serve as important birth narratives that convey the life and teachings of Sikh Gurus. These stories describe the miraculous events surrounding the Gurus' births, emphasizing their divinity and the special purpose they were destined to fulfill. By sharing these narratives, janam-sakhis help to instill a sense of reverence and understanding of the Gurus' teachings among Sikhs. Additionally, they highlight key moral and spiritual lessons that are central to Sikh beliefs, making the teachings of the Gurus accessible and relatable to followers. Through these narratives, the janam-sakhis play a crucial role in preserving and promoting Sikh identity and spirituality.

Note: correct because it emphasizes how janam-sakhis illustrate the divine nature and significance of the Gurus' births, thereby enhancing the understanding and reverence for their teachings and moral lessons within Sikhism.